Chapter 33

Cop of the World:
Destiny Takes Her to the United Nations

KIRAN WAS EVENTUALLY PROMOTED TO THE RANK OF SPECIAL commissioner of police in 2002. This elevation brought her closer to the ultimate responsibility: that of leading her 'favourite' Delhi Police one day as the police commissioner. This was a position that large numbers of her admirers and well-wishers were anxiously waiting for her to occupy.

As special commissioner (intelligence), her main job functions involved the collation and analysis of political intelligence. They also comprised sending out special alerts and briefing seniors, including political bosses on political trends. This was a highly sensitive position as it meant keeping very close track of the political fluctuations and machinations, which were essential for political parties to know. In view of its crucial nature, her post had a huge potential for getting used/abused. Therefore, Kiran's neutrality and objectivity caused some insecurity in her bosses, both within her own service as well as outside, i.e., among the political bigwigs. Her own boss, the police commissioner, started editing her reports so as to ensure that what was sent to his political boss was *politically* correct.

Further, as soon as Kiran took charge of this post, the Special Operations Cell, known for many 'encounters', was taken off her list of responsibilities. No reasons were given. And then, within a few weeks, the cell carried out an 'encounter' – a matter that is sub judice.

Kiran's boss was the person who had succeeded her in Tihar jail as the IGP. It was widely known then amongst the Tihar rank and file that he punished all those NGOs or staff members who, even by accident, attributed prison reform work to her. The incumbent hated Kiran for her popularity.

As destiny would have it, the same man was now the Delhi police commissioner and Kiran his junior as special commissioner. On his assuming charge as the head of the Delhi Police, Kiran went to pay a courtesy call on him, knowing fully well that he was no friend. She said outrightly: '*You are the police commissioner and you have the right to select your team. I will be grateful if you let me know as soon as you decide whether I will be a part of your team or not. Because in case I'm not, I'd like to have some fallback*.' To this he promptly answered, as if instead of listening to Kiran, he had a query to slap on her: '*Tell me, why is it always with you: Goa, traffic, lawyers, Tihar Jail. Mizoram, Chandigarh, etc.?*' To which Kiran replied: '*Sir, this would need a little longer time and since this is only a courtesy call, I will be grateful if it be left at this*.'

As if this was not enough, he fired another shot and said: '*You will not write hereafter*.' (Kiran used to write a fortnightly column tilted 'Reflections' in *The Tribune*.) Kiran asked: '*Why sir?*' To which the police commissioner replied: '*Because I tell you so*.' Kiran looked the police commissioner in the eye, treating him as her equal, and asserted: '*I will not stop writing. This is my creative right*.' She then got up and left.